

Talk 3: Questions About Babies, Sex & Where We Come From

Ages 6–8

Introduction

Hi, and welcome to Bright Talks.

As parents, many of us want our children to grow up feeling confident, safe, and comfortable coming to us with their questions. But as those questions become more specific, it can sometimes feel harder to know exactly what to say.

At six, seven, and eight, questions about babies, pregnancy, growing bodies, and things they may have heard from others can begin to come up.

And when they do, you might find yourself wondering:

"How much should I actually tell them?"

The good news is that you don't have to explain everything at once.

Today, we're going to talk about how to answer these bigger questions honestly, simply, and in a way that meets your child right where they are.

Start With What They Already Know

When your child asks, *"How are babies made?"* resist the urge to immediately launch into an explanation.

Remember what we've been practicing:

Stay curious.

Try asking:

"What made you think about that?"

or,

"What do you already know about where babies come from?"

Their answer gives you a starting point.

Maybe they're wondering how a baby gets inside a mother's body.

Maybe a friend said something at school.

Maybe someone in your family is pregnant.

Understanding the question behind the question helps you give your child the information they're actually looking for.

Answer. Pause. Listen.

Here's a simple approach you can use:

Answer. Pause. Listen.

First, keep your answer simple, truthful, and appropriate for what your child is asking.

You might say:

"Babies begin with something very small from a mom called an egg and something very small from a dad called sperm. When they come together, a baby can begin to grow inside the mom's uterus."

Then pause.

Give your child a moment to take that in.

They may be completely satisfied with that answer and move right along to something else.

Or they may have another question.

Either response is okay.

If they ask how the sperm and egg come together, you can add another layer:

"One way a pregnancy can begin is through something called sexual intercourse. This is a private way adults can share intimacy, and it allows sperm from the man's body to reach an egg inside the woman's body. If you have questions about how that happens, you can always ask me."

Then pause again.

You aren't avoiding the next question.

You're simply allowing your child to decide when they're ready to ask it.

When Bigger Questions Come Up

As children grow, they may hear words or ask questions that surprise you, including questions about sex.

Remember, your child's understanding of a word may be very different from yours.

Before explaining, stay curious.

You might simply ask:

"What have you heard about that?"

or,

"What do you think that means?"

Their answer will help you understand what they're really asking and how much they're ready to know.

If they're asking about how babies begin, you can explain that sexual intercourse is one way adults can share intimacy that may lead to pregnancy.

You don't have to explain every detail unless your child continues asking questions.

For Christian families, you can also gently connect the conversation to your family's beliefs:

"We believe God created our bodies, love, marriage, and families with purpose. As you get older, we'll keep talking about what that means together."

The goal isn't to give your child everything they will eventually need to know.

It's to give them enough truth for today and the confidence to come back tomorrow.

Science and Faith Together

Science gives us an incredible understanding of how human life begins.

At this age, children can begin learning simple biological concepts like eggs, sperm, pregnancy, and how babies grow inside the uterus.

And those scientific truths can exist naturally alongside your family's faith.

As Christians, we believe human life has value and that our bodies, relationships, marriage, and sexuality are part of God's intentional design.

Science helps us understand how our bodies and reproduction work.

Faith helps us talk about the meaning, responsibility, love, and values surrounding them.

We don't have to teach everything at once.

Both of these conversations can deepen as your child grows.

It's Okay If This Feels Awkward

If these conversations weren't modeled for you growing up, even saying words like *sperm*, *egg*, or *sexual intercourse* with your child may feel uncomfortable at first.

That's okay.

You don't have to pretend the conversation feels effortless.

What's important is that our discomfort doesn't accidentally communicate that their curiosity is something to be embarrassed about.

Take your time.

Stay calm.

And if you're caught completely off guard, you can always say:

"That's an important question. I want to give you a good answer. Can we talk about it a little later?"

Just make sure you come back to it.

Every time you do, you're reinforcing something important:

"You can ask me about this."

Key Takeaway

You don't need to give your six, seven, or eight year old everything you know about reproduction.

Give them what they're ready for.

Answer honestly. Pause. Listen.

If another question comes, answer that question too.

Over time, those small conversations build a much bigger understanding of bodies, reproduction, relationships, and your family's values.

More importantly, they build trust.

Wrapping Up

As we finish today's lesson, remember that your goal isn't to have one perfect conversation.

It's to create a relationship where your child never has to wonder whether they're allowed to ask.

Stay curious.

Use truthful, age appropriate language.

Let their questions guide the pace.

And remember that every calm answer today makes it easier for your child to come back tomorrow.

As children become more independent, however, knowing the facts is only part of what they need.

They also need confidence navigating situations when you aren't right beside them.

In our next talk, Boundaries, Secrets & Staying Safe, we'll build on what your child already knows about body safety and help you prepare them for friendships, school, activities, trusted adults, secrets, and situations that simply don't feel right.

Because as their independence grows, we want their confidence and their voice to grow with it.

We'll see you in the next lesson.